LESSON 1

Hot Cross Buns

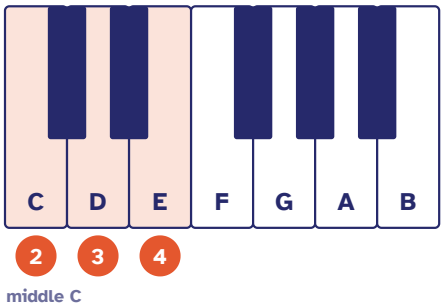
A street cry: bakers sang it in London on Good Friday to sell their spiced buns. It was written down in 1733.

IN THIS SONG **three notes: E D C** **steps down** **walk and run-ning** **fingers 4 3 2**

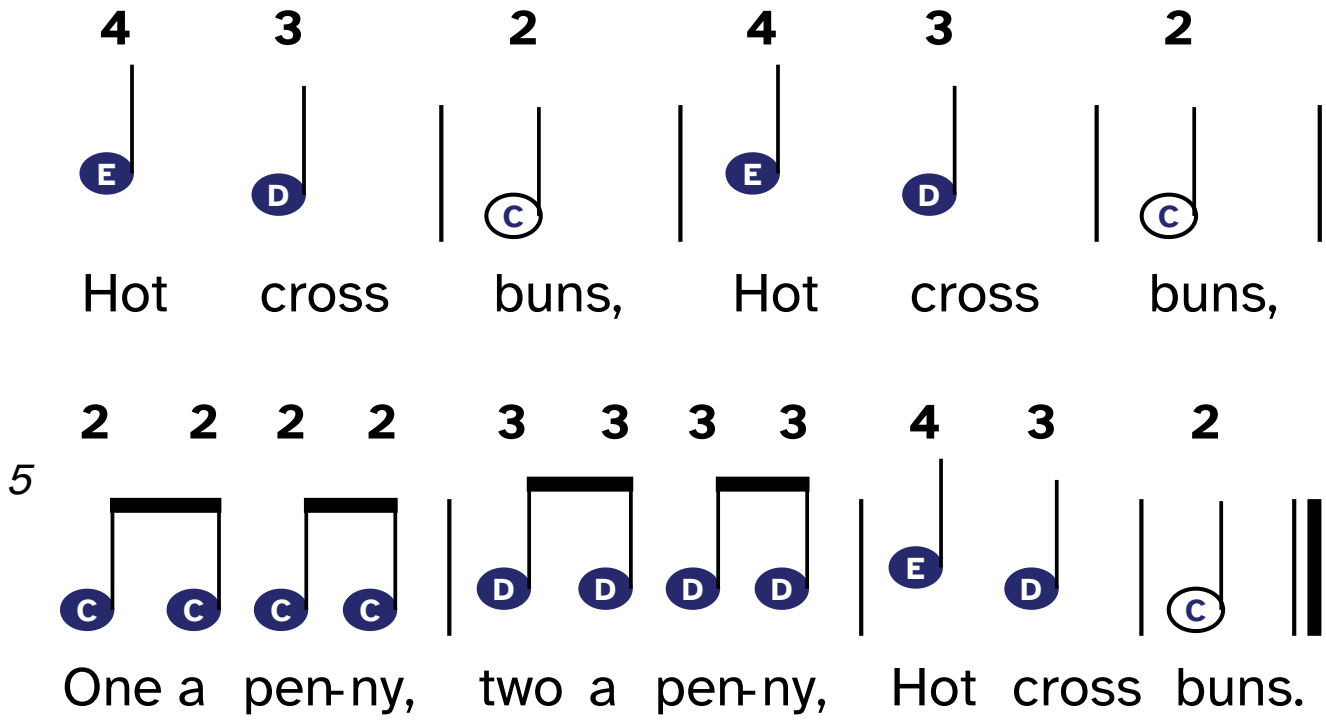
LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it with the words, then on the letter names.



Your hand. Right hand: finger 2 on middle C, 3 on D, 4 on E. Three middle fingers, the easiest to start with.
Steps down. Each note is the next key down: E, D, C. On the page each one sits a step lower, so the tune looks the way it sounds.



- [ ] Listened and pointed
- [ ] Sang it with the words
- [ ] Sang the letter names

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE BEAT

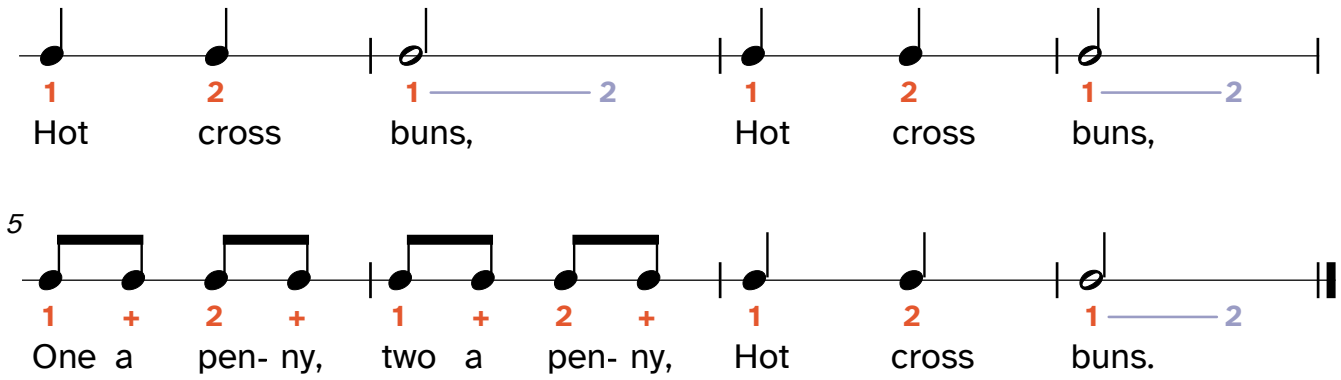
Count 1 2 in every bar, steady as a clock: two beats a bar.
Walk on a beat; run two quick notes in one beat: say *pen-ny*, count *1 +*.

THE NOTES

crotchet: walk
1 beat

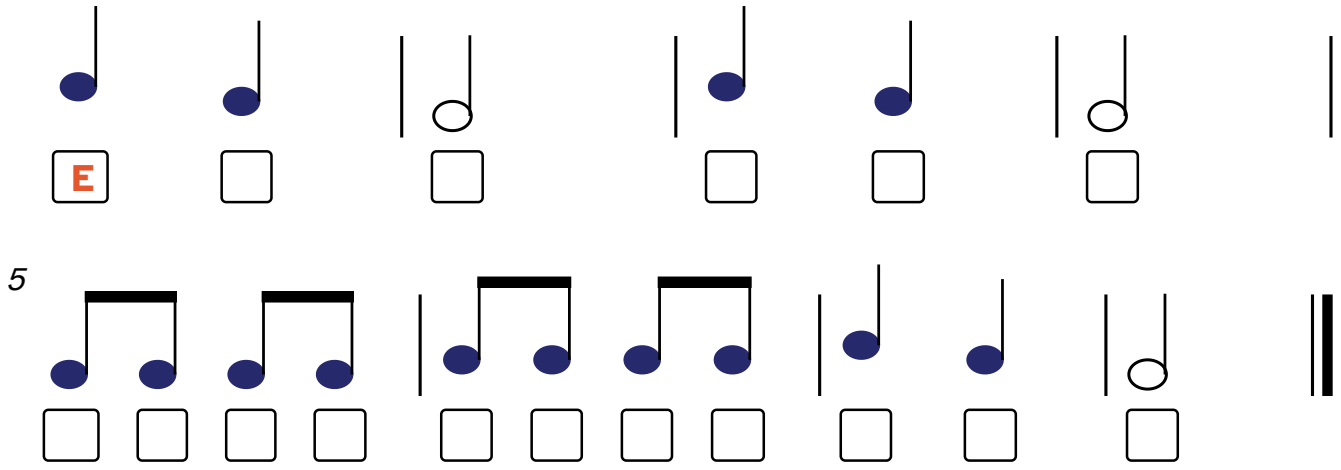
two quavers: run-ning
1 beat

minim
2 beats



THE NOTES

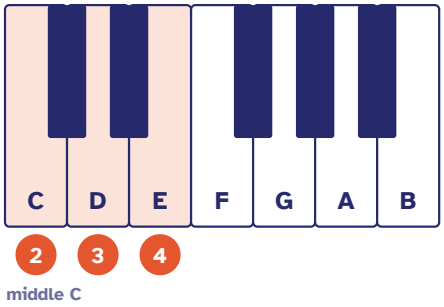
Now the notes are empty. Write E, D or C in each box, then sing it on the letter names.



- [ ] **Said it in time**
- [ ] **Clapped and counted**
- [ ] **Ran on “one a penny”**
- [ ] **Wrote the letter names**

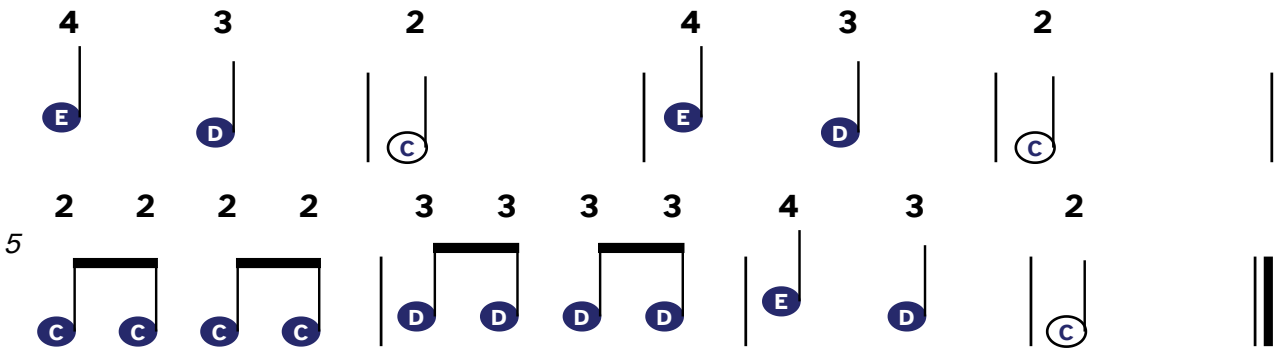
3 Play it

The white keys C D E, with the right hand, then the left.

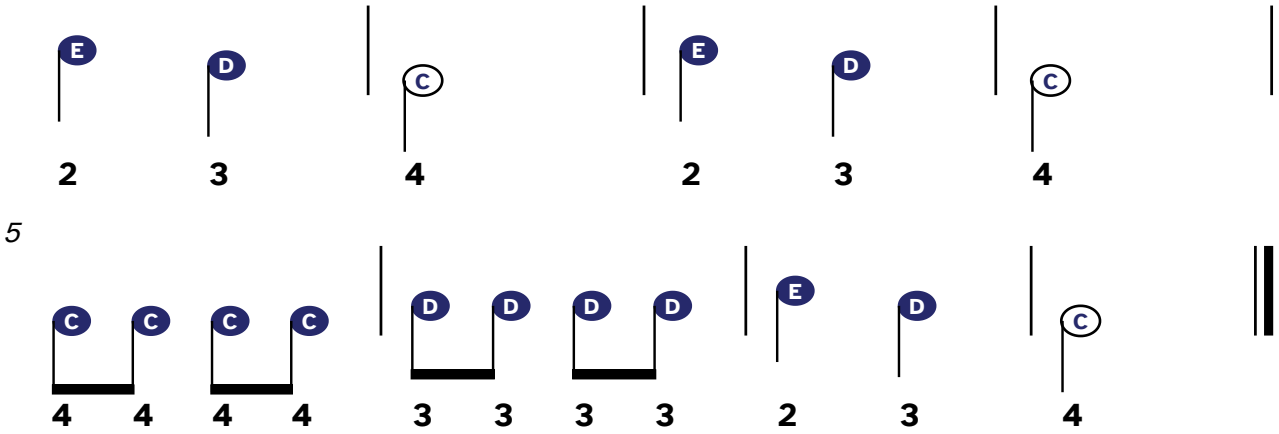


Right hand: 2 on middle C, 3 on D, 4 on E. **Left hand:** an octave lower, 4 on C, 3 on D, 2 on E.

R RIGHT HAND 4 3 2



L LEFT HAND 2 3 4, an octave lower



4 · CHECK

- ☐ I can say and clap it
- ☐ I can sing it with the words
- ☐ I can sing the letter names

I can play it:

- ☐ Right hand ☐ Left hand

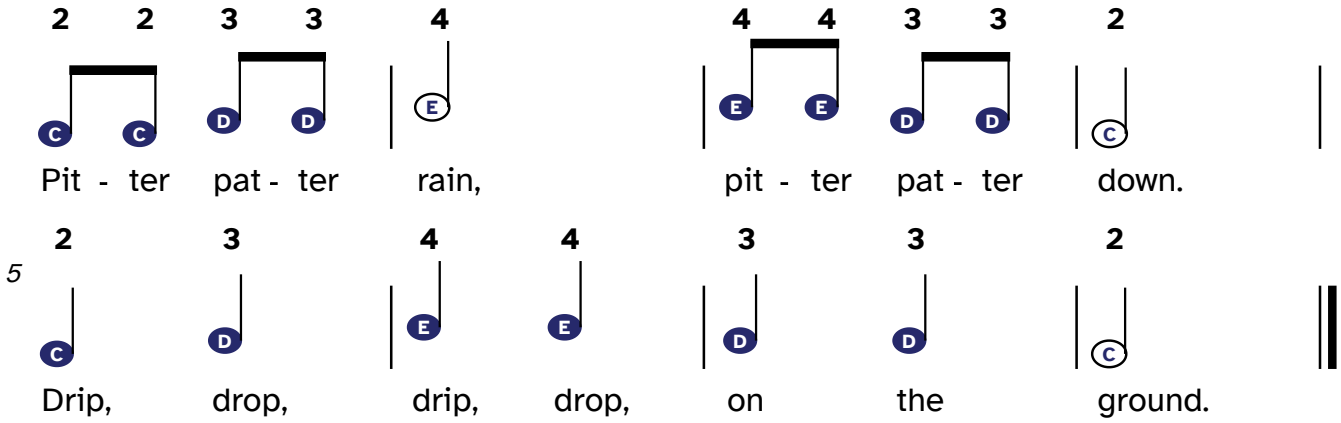
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

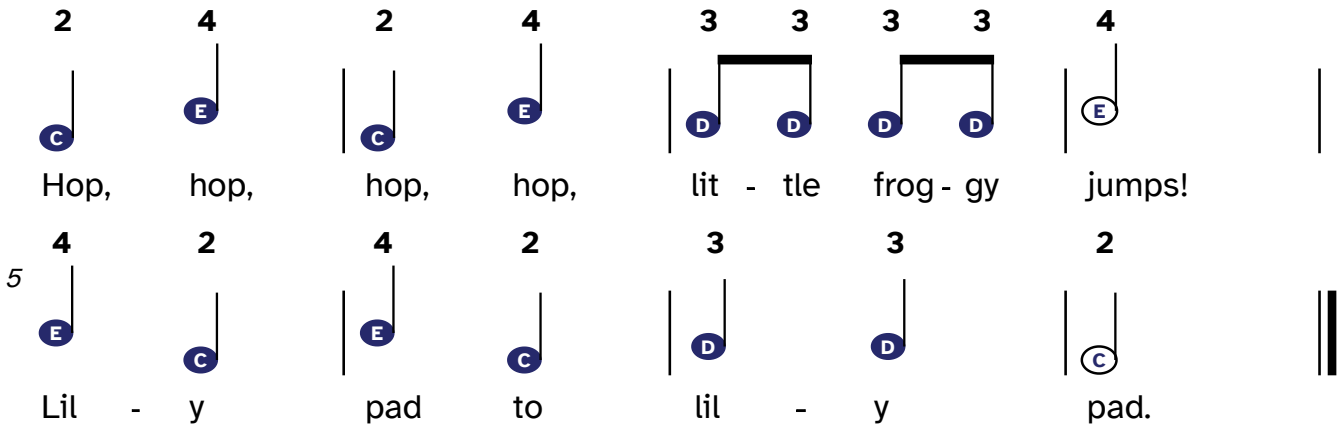
PITTER PATTER

Light and quick, like rain: the same three keys, now climbing up from C. Say it, then play it.



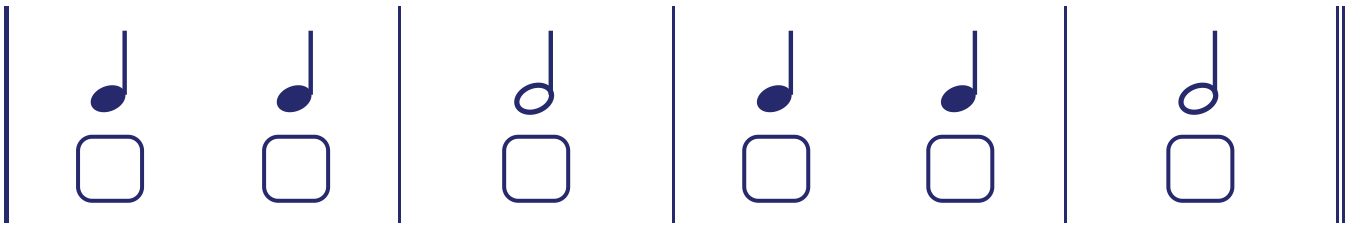
FROGGY HOPS

Bouncy, a peek at Lesson 2: the frog hops from C to E and back, missing D. That jump is a skip.



YOUR OWN TUNE

Write a letter in each box, then play your tune. Give it a name: _____



☐ **Played the first tune** ☐ **Played the second tune** ☐ **Played my own tune**